



**₹7.5 lakh cr**

**Food and  
beverages**



**₹5.1 lakh cr**

**Textiles  
and apparel**

startling. A lot more needs to be done when one inevitably compares India with China, but there is reason to be happy.

Abhijit Roy, MD & CEO of Berger Paints India, says Indian manufacturing is at an inflection point. “For many years, we spoke about its potential and, today, that conversation is shifting towards manufacturing leadership,” he says.

## IMPROVE, INNOVATE

Roy says a few factors have come together at the right time and presented India a big opportunity; India is one of the fastest growing major economies, investment in

infrastructure is improving connectivity, digital technologies are becoming more accessible and policy initiatives are underway to create a stronger manufacturing ecosystem. This at a time when global businesses are looking for supply chains that are dependable, resilient and diversified. “Unlike many economies that first built factories and then created demand, India has the benefit of a large and growing domestic market,” he says.

“That gives manufacturers an opportunity to learn, improve, innovate and scale in a highly competitive environment before taking these capabilities to global markets. In many ways, India’s domestic market has become a training ground for building globally competitive businesses,” adds Roy.

## THE COMPLEXITY

True, India’s domestic market throws up infinite possibilities but cracking the code is not easy even in the best of times. Complexities exist given the heterogeneity of the market. But that often makes companies extremely robust.

“Those operating in India have to cater to multiple income segments, regional preferences and consumption habits, which drives innovation and adaptability,” says Saugata Gupta, MD & CEO of Marico, the maker of Parachute hair oil.

Over time, that story has matured and is today a reflection of a changing and more confident India. “As we consciously diversified our portfolio beyond traditional FMCG (fast moving consumer goods) categories into healthy foods, men’s grooming, nutraceuticals and premium personal care, our manufacturing capabilities also evolved alongside,” says Gupta.

Food products, as he puts it, require greater innovation,



**“Steel plants require continuous investment in technology, safety, decarbonisation and new products”**

**AMIT HARLALKA**  
CEO, ARCELORMITTAL  
NIPPON STEEL INDIA



**“For years, we spoke about Indian manufacturing’s potential and today, that conversation is shifting towards leadership”**

**ABHIJIT ROY**  
MD & CEO,  
BERGER PAINTS INDIA



**“For China, it was about scale and state-directed capital while Germany did it through precision engineering and vocational depth”**

**VISHAL SHARMA**  
ED & CEO, GODREJ  
INDUSTRIES (CHEMICALS)